Small Biz Digital Toolkit

By **Gonzalo Aguilar** · Free guide · No email required · Updated April 2026

You don't need a big agency budget or a tech team to have a digital presence that actually works. What you need is a clear checklist, the right free tools, and the habit of checking in regularly.

This toolkit is everything a small business owner needs to go from "our website exists" to "our website actually brings in customers." No jargon. No $5,000/month tools. Just the real stuff that works.

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1. Landing Page Checklist (50 Items)

A landing page has one job: turn a visitor into a customer, lead, or subscriber. Every element either helps or hurts that goal. Run through this list on any page you want to convert better.

Above the Fold (what people see without scrolling)

- ☐ The headline tells me what this is in under 5 seconds
- ☐ The headline is about what I get, not what you do

- [ ] There is a visible, specific call-to-action (not just "Learn More")
- [ ] The page loads in under 3 seconds (test at PageSpeed Insights)
- [ ] The page looks good on mobile — no horizontal scrolling, readable text
- [ ] The logo links back to your homepage
- [ ] There is a phone number or contact method visible without scrolling
- [ ] The hero image (if any) supports the message — not just stock-photo filler

Value and Clarity

- [ ] It's clear who this is for (name the customer type, problem, or situation)
- [ ] The main benefit is stated in plain English, not jargon
- [ ] You've described the outcome, not just the feature ("save 5 hours a week" not "automated scheduling")
- [ ] There is a subheadline that adds context to the main headline
- [ ] I understand what the product or service actually is within 10 seconds
- [ ] The copy sounds like a human, not a corporate brochure
- [ ] You've answered the question "why should I choose you over everyone else?"
- [ ] Prices are visible (or there's a clear reason they aren't — like "call for a custom quote")

Trust Signals

- [ ] There is at least one testimonial from a real customer
- [ ] Testimonials include the customer's name and context (not just "Great product! — J.S.")
- [ ] If you have reviews on Google or Yelp, the rating is visible
- [ ] If you have media mentions or awards, they are shown
- [ ] There is a photo of a real person (you, your team, your work) — not just stock imagery
- [ ] There's a clear explanation of what happens after someone submits a form or contacts you

- [ ] If you collect payment online, there are security badges near the checkout
- [ ] Your business address or service area is listed (shows you're real and local)
- [ ] A privacy policy is linked (required legally and builds trust)

The Call to Action

- [ ] There is one primary CTA — not three or four competing buttons
- [ ] The CTA button text is specific ("Book a Free Consultation" not "Submit")
- [ ] The CTA button stands out visually — contrast in color, size, or whitespace
- [ ] The CTA appears at least twice on the page (above the fold and near the bottom)
- [ ] If there's a form, it asks only for what you actually need — every extra field costs conversions
- [ ] After submitting the form, the user gets a confirmation message or email
- [ ] The form works on mobile — fields are large enough to tap, keyboard doesn't obscure Submit

SEO and Technical

- [ ] The page title (browser tab) includes your primary keyword and location if local
- [ ] The meta description is written (not auto-generated) and includes a call-to-action
- [ ] Images have descriptive alt text (describes what's in the image)
- [ ] The URL is clean: /services/plumbing-repair — not /page?id=4827
- [ ] There is exactly one H1 (the main headline) — not zero, not three
- [ ] The page is indexed by Google (search "site:yourdomain.com/page-url" to check)
- [ ] HTTPS is enabled (padlock icon in browser) — visitors get a warning without it

Content Quality

- [ ] There are no spelling or grammar errors

- [ ] All links on the page work (test every one)
- [ ] No broken images or layout issues
- [ ] The most important info is near the top, not buried
- [ ] Paragraphs are short (3-4 sentences max) — walls of text lose readers
- [ ] There is a clear answer to "what do I do next?" at every scroll depth
- [ ] If you have a chat widget, it doesn't block the main content on mobile

For Local Businesses Specifically

- [ ] Your city and neighborhood are mentioned in the copy (not just the address)
- [ ] Your Google Business Profile is claimed and linked
- [ ] Your hours are correct and visible
- [ ] An embedded Google Map is present on your contact or location page
- [ ] Service area is clear if you travel to customers

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2. GA4 Setup Guide — Step by Step

Google Analytics 4 is free and tells you a lot about how people find and use your website. The setup takes about 2 hours and pays dividends forever. Here's exactly how to do it.

> **BEFORE YOU START**
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> You need: a Google account, access to your website's code or a CMS like WordPress/Squarespace/Wix, and about 90 minutes. That's it.

1 Create your GA4 property

Go to **analytics.google.com**. Click "Start measuring." Give your account a name (your business name). Create a property (your website). Fill in your business category and size. Click Create. You'll get a Property ID that looks like "G-XXXXXXXXXX" — save this.

2 Add the tracking code to your website

WordPress: Install the "Google Site Kit" plugin, connect it with your Google account, and authorize GA4. It adds the code automatically.
Squarespace: Settings → Integrations → Google Analytics → paste your G-XXXXXXXXXX code.
Wix: Dashboard → Marketing & SEO → Marketing Integrations → Google Analytics.
Custom website: Copy the "gtag.js" snippet from GA4 (Admin → Data Streams → your stream → View tag instructions) and paste it before the </head> tag on every page.

3 Verify the code is working

Go to GA4 → Reports → Real-time. Open your website in another tab and navigate around. Within 30 seconds you should see "1 user in last 30 minutes." If you see zero, the code isn't installed correctly — double-check step 2. Also install the Chrome extension "Google Tag Assistant" to confirm tags are firing.

4 Set up a conversion event

A conversion is the most important action on your site — a form submission, a phone call click, a booking. In GA4: Admin → Events. Find the event that fires when someone submits your contact form (usually "form_submit" or a "thank you page" page view). Click the three dots → Mark as conversion. Now GA4 tracks your most important business metric.
If you don't see a relevant event, use Google Tag Manager (free) to create a custom event that fires on your thank-you page URL.

5 Connect Google Search Console

Search Console shows what search terms people used to find your site. In GA4: Admin → Property Settings → Search Console Links. Authorize. This connects your search data to your traffic data — you'll see which keywords bring people to your site AND what they do after they arrive.

6 Create a simple dashboard

GA4 → Explore → Blank → create a free-form exploration with these rows: Page title. And these metrics: Sessions, Engagement rate, Conversions. This gives you a one-view snapshot of which pages drive business. Check this monthly (see Section 7 for the habit).

7 Filter out your own traffic

If you visit your own website regularly, it pollutes your data. Admin → Data Streams → your stream → More tagging settings → Define internal traffic. Add your office IP address(es). Then Admin → Data Filters → activate the "Internal Traffic" filter. Now your own visits are excluded.

THE ONE REPORT TO CHECK MONTHLY

Reports → Acquisition → Traffic Acquisition. It shows how people found you: organic search, direct, social, referral. This tells you where to invest your marketing time. If 80% of your traffic is "direct" (people typing your URL), you have an opportunity to grow your search and social presence.

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3. SEO Basics: 10 Things Every Small Business Website Needs

SEO sounds technical but most of it is just: make your website clear about who you are, where you are, and what you do. Google is remarkably good at understanding clear, well-organized content.

1. **A clear, keyword-rich title tag for every page.**
   Your title tag is the blue link Google shows in search results. It should include your main service and location. "Joe's Plumbing — Emergency Plumber in Austin, TX" beats "Joe's Plumbing Services."
2. **A written meta description for every page.**
   The snippet that appears below your title in search results. Write it like a tiny ad: include what you do, who you help, and a call-to-action. 150-160 characters max.
3. **One H1 tag per page that includes your main keyword.**
   The H1 is your page's main headline. Google reads it to understand what the page is about. "Emergency Plumbing Repair in Austin" is a good H1. "Welcome to our website" is not.
4. **Your city and service area in your content — naturally.**
   If you're a local business, your location needs to be in the text, not just the footer. "We've been serving Austin homeowners since 2008" tells Google you're a local business.
5. **A Google Business Profile (formerly Google My Business).**
   Free. Essential. If you have a physical location or serve a local area, this is the most important single SEO action you can take. It's what makes you appear in the Google Maps pack. Keep hours, phone, and address current.

6. **Fast page speed — especially on mobile.**
   Google uses page speed as a ranking factor. Test with Google's PageSpeed Insights. Common culprits: unoptimized images, too many plugins, cheap hosting. Images should be under 200KB each.
7. **HTTPS (secure connection).**
   Not optional anymore. Visitors see a "Not Secure" warning in browsers for HTTP sites. Most hosting providers now include free SSL certificates — turn it on if you haven't.
8. **Content that answers the actual questions your customers ask.**
   A page titled "How much does a bathroom remodel cost in Denver?" will rank for that exact query. Think about what people type into Google before they hire someone like you — and write pages that answer those questions.
9. **Internal links between your pages.**
   Link from your homepage to your main service pages. Link from blog posts to your service pages. This helps Google understand your site structure and spreads authority to your most important pages.
10. **A consistent NAP (Name, Address, Phone) everywhere you appear online.**
    Your business name, address, and phone number should be identical on your website, Google Business Profile, Yelp, Facebook, and any directories. Inconsistency confuses both Google and customers.

> **WHAT NOT TO WASTE TIME ON**
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> Keyword stuffing (repeating your keyword 50 times), link schemes, fake reviews, or buying SEO software subscriptions you don't understand. These either don't work or actively hurt you. The fundamentals above will do more than any hack.

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4. Email Capture Strategy: 5 Lead Magnet Ideas

Your email list is the one audience you own. Social platforms can change their algorithm or shut down tomorrow — your email list is yours. Here's how to grow it with something genuinely useful.

A lead magnet is a free resource you give visitors in exchange for their email address. The key word is "genuinely useful" — if it's not actually valuable, people will unsubscribe immediately or mark you as spam.

> **THE RULE**

> Your lead magnet should be something people would pay a small amount for if you charged for it. If it's not that valuable, make it more valuable — don't make them more persuasive. Quality > quantity in email list building.

Lead Magnet Idea 1: The "Before You Hire" Checklist

What it is: A downloadable PDF checklist that helps your target customer make a better buying decision — whether or not they hire you.

Example: A landscaper creates "7 Questions to Ask Any Landscaper Before You Sign a Contract." A wedding photographer creates "What to Look for in a Wedding Photographer: The Complete Checklist."

Why it works: It positions you as the trustworthy expert. It gets your name in their hands when they're actively in buying mode. It's easy to create (it's your expertise).

Lead Magnet Idea 2: The "Quick Win" Guide

What it is: A short, actionable guide that helps your customer solve a small version of the problem you solve professionally.

Example: A bookkeeper creates "3 Things to Do With Your Receipts Every Month to Make Tax Season Painless." A personal trainer creates "The 15-Minute Morning Routine That Actually Works."

Why it works: It demonstrates your expertise without giving everything away. When they're ready for help with the big problem, they already trust you.

Lead Magnet Idea 3: The Template or Swipe File

What it is: A ready-to-use template, spreadsheet, or script your customer can immediately use.

Example: A social media consultant creates "The 30-Day Social Media Content Calendar (Filled In for You)." A lawyer creates "The 5 Contract Clauses Every Freelancer Needs." A florist creates "Wedding Flower Budget Template."

Why it works: Templates are perceived as extremely high value because they save time immediately. The specificity tells customers this person really understands my situation.

Lead Magnet Idea 4: The Email Course

What it is: A 5-7 email sequence delivered over 5-7 days, each email teaching one thing related to your expertise.

Example: "5 Days to a Website That Actually Gets You Customers" or "The Week-1 Homeowner Maintenance Checklist."

Why it works: Gives you 5+ touchpoints with the subscriber before they're ready to buy. Builds familiarity and trust systematically. More engaging than a single download.

Lead Magnet Idea 5: The Local Discount or Priority Access

What it is: A simple offer — "Join our list for 10% off your first order" or "Get first access to new service openings."

Example: A restaurant: "Join the list for our monthly special menu announcement — list members get early reservations." A contractor: "Email subscribers get priority scheduling during our busy season."

Why it works: Straightforward and doesn't require creating a resource. Works especially well for service businesses with capacity constraints or retail businesses with returning customers.

> **THE TOOL TO USE**
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> MailerLite and Brevo (formerly Sendinblue) both have free tiers that handle email collection and automated sequences for up to 1,000 subscribers. Start with either — they're both beginner-friendly and don't require a developer.

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5. Social Media Content Calendar Template

Consistency beats brilliance on social media. You don't need to go viral — you need to show up regularly so that when someone is ready to hire someone like you, they already know you exist.

This is a 4-week rolling template. Repeat it monthly with fresh content. Each week has a theme to keep you from staring at a blank page.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
WEEK 1 — EDUCATE Share a tip your ideal customer doesn't know. "Did you know that..."	**WEEK 1 — EDUCATE** Myth vs. fact in your industry. Something customers commonly get wrong.	**WEEK 1 — EDUCATE** Behind the scenes: show how you do what you do. Process content builds trust.	**WEEK 1 — EDUCATE** Answer a question you get all the time. "The most common question I get is..."	**WEEK 1 — EDUCATE** Reshare something useful from another account + add your perspective.
WEEK 2 — SOCIAL PROOF Customer story or testimonial. Use a real quote if you have permission.	**WEEK 2 — SOCIAL PROOF** Before/after or result you're proud of from recent work.	**WEEK 2 — SOCIAL PROOF** "We just finished..." — show completed work with a brief story.	**WEEK 2 — SOCIAL PROOF** A thank-you post to a happy customer (with their permission).	**WEEK 2 — SOCIAL PROOF** Milestone or anniversary worth celebrating. Numbers are engaging.
WEEK 3 — PERSONALITY Your story: why you started this business. Personal connection builds loyalty.	**WEEK 3 — PERSONALITY** What you're currently working on or thinking about.	**WEEK 3 — PERSONALITY** Something local: a community event, a shoutout to a local business you love.	**WEEK 3 — PERSONALITY** Your opinion on something in your industry. Take a small stand.	**WEEK 3 — PERSONALITY** A team member or collaborator spotlight. Humanizes the business.
WEEK 4 — CONVERT Promote your service or product directly. This is the ask. Keep it benefit-focused.	**WEEK 4 — CONVERT** FAQ about your service. Removes buying objections before they form.	**WEEK 4 — CONVERT** Promote your lead magnet (from Section 4). Grow the email list.	**WEEK 4 — CONVERT** Limited offer, seasonal promotion, or early-access opportunity if you have one.	**WEEK 4 — CONVERT** Direct CTA post. "If you need [X], I can help. Here's how to get started."

PRACTICAL TIPS

Pick 1-2 platforms, not 5. Where your customers actually spend time. For most local service businesses: Facebook + Instagram or just Google Business Profile posts.

Batch your content. Set aside 2 hours on one day per month to plan and draft the entire month.

> Then schedule it.
>
> **A photo of you or your work beats stock images** every single time on social.

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6. Free Tools List: 20 Free Tools Organized by Category

ANALYTICS

Google Analytics 4 FREE

Track website traffic, user behavior, and conversions. The standard for a reason.

ANALYTICS

Google Search Console FREE

See what Google search terms bring people to your site. Essential for SEO.

ANALYTICS

Hotjar (Free Tier) FREE

Heatmaps and session recordings. See where visitors click and where they stop reading.

ANALYTICS

Microsoft Clarity FREE

Heatmaps and session recordings with no traffic limits. Completely free alternative to Hotjar paid tiers.

EMAIL MARKETING

MailerLite FREE

Free up to 1,000 subscribers. Easy to use, solid templates, handles automations well.

EMAIL MARKETING

Brevo (formerly Sendinblue) FREE

Free up to 300 emails/day. Good for transactional emails and campaigns. No subscriber limit on free plan.

DESIGN

Canva FREE

Social media graphics, flyers, presentations. Drag-and-drop. No design skills required.

DESIGN

Remove.bg FREE

Remove image backgrounds in one click. Makes product photos look professional instantly.

SEO

Google Business Profile FREE

SEO

Ubersuggest (Free Tier) FREE

The most important local SEO tool. Shows you in Google Maps. Manage reviews. Post updates.

Keyword research, competitor analysis, and site audit. Free tier is limited but useful for basics.

SEO

Google PageSpeed Insights FREE

Test your page speed on mobile and desktop. Tells you exactly what's slowing you down.

SCHEDULING & BOOKING

Calendly (Free Tier) FREE

Let customers book appointments without the back-and-forth emails. One event type free.

SCHEDULING & BOOKING

Square Appointments FREE

Booking + payment in one. Free for individuals. Great for service businesses.

FORMS & SURVEYS

Google Forms FREE

Contact forms, surveys, job applications. Connects to Google Sheets automatically.

FORMS & SURVEYS

Tally FREE

More beautiful form builder than Google Forms. Free tier is generous. Great for embedded forms.

SOCIAL MEDIA

Buffer (Free Tier) FREE

Schedule posts to 3 social channels. Great for batching your monthly content in one session.

SOCIAL MEDIA

Later (Free Tier) FREE

Visual content calendar for Instagram, Facebook, TikTok. Drag-and-drop scheduling.

AI WRITING

ChatGPT (Free Tier) FREE

Write social captions, email drafts, product descriptions, FAQs. First draft in 30 seconds.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Unsplash / Pexels FREE

High-quality free stock photos. No attribution required. Better than the obvious stock imagery.

VIDEO

CapCut FREE

Video editing with auto-captions, templates, and effects. Great for Reels and TikTok. No experience needed.

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7. Monthly Review Template

The difference between businesses that grow online and those that don't is usually this: one has a regular habit of checking what's working and adjusting. This takes 30 minutes, once a month.

Schedule it on the same day every month — first Monday morning, last Friday afternoon, whatever works. Treat it like a real appointment.

Traffic Review (10 minutes)

- ☐ Open GA4 → Compare this month vs. last month: Total sessions, new users, engagement rate
- ☐ Which channel drove the most traffic? (organic, direct, social, referral)
- ☐ Which channel grew the most vs. last month? Which shrank?
- ☐ Which pages had the highest traffic? Are these the pages I want driving traffic?
- ☐ What was my bounce rate (or engagement rate) on the top 5 pages?

Conversion Review (5 minutes)

- ☐ How many conversions (form fills, calls, bookings) came from the website this month?
- ☐ What's my conversion rate? (conversions ÷ sessions × 100)
- ☐ Which page had the most conversions? Which had zero?
- ☐ Did I make any changes last month that might have affected conversions? Did they help or hurt?

SEO Review (5 minutes)

- ☐ Open Google Search Console → Check impressions and clicks vs. last month
- ☐ What are my top 5 search queries? Am I showing up for the right terms?
- ☐ Are any pages losing ranking? (Queries sorted by position decline)

- ☐ Did I publish any new content this month? Is Google indexing it?

Email Review (5 minutes)

- ☐ How many new email subscribers did I gain this month?
- ☐ Open rate on my last campaign: is it above 25%? Below 25% means subject line work needed.
- ☐ Did I email my list at least once this month?
- ☐ Any replies or replies that I should turn into a customer story?

Social Media Review (5 minutes)

- ☐ Which post got the most engagement this month? Why do you think it resonated?
- ☐ How many followers did I gain or lose?
- ☐ Did I post consistently? (At least 3x/week on primary platform)
- ☐ Any comments or DMs I haven't responded to?

One Action for Next Month

- ☐ Based on this review, the one thing I'll do differently next month is: _____
- ☐ The one page I'll improve based on this month's data: _____
- ☐ The one piece of content I'll create that I know would help my customers: _____

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING

You don't need to do everything at once. Pick one section of this toolkit, implement it well, and add the next section next month. A partial toolkit consistently executed beats a complete toolkit ignored.

> **Progress beats perfection every time.**

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